

D616

Consumer Behavior

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Maria's 12-year-old washing machine, bought from a store that has since closed, stops working. She has already read online reviews and narrowed her list to three models. Now she is comparing their energy ratings, capacity, and price side by side. Which stage is she in?

- A. Post-purchase evaluation.
- B. Information search.
- C. Need recognition.
- D. Evaluation of alternatives.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A runner sees an app alert showing his shoes have logged 500 miles, the point where cushioning usually wears out. He had not planned to buy new shoes. Which stage did the alert trigger?

- A. Information search.
- B. Need recognition.
- C. Evaluation of alternatives.
- D. Purchase.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A home security company's ad, featuring a famous actor, shows a family sleeping soundly while the system guards the doors. The ad ran during a championship game. Which need does it mainly target?

- A. Esteem, because of the famous actor.
- B. Belonging.
- C. Physiological.
- D. Safety.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A first-time buyer plans to spend \$30,000 on a car. Her cousin works at a dealership across town. She spends weeks reading reviews, test-driving, and comparing loan terms. What kind of decision is this?

- A. Extended problem solving.
- B. Impulse buying.
- C. Routine response behavior.
- D. Limited problem solving.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A soft drink brand, which changed its logo last year, runs ads that always pair its can with upbeat summer music and friends laughing at the beach. Over time, viewers feel happy just seeing the can. What learning process is at work?

- A. Brand recognition from the new logo.
- B. Classical conditioning.
- C. Operant conditioning.
- D. Observational learning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A coffee shop gives a free drink after every ten purchases, and customers start visiting more often. Which learning process is this?

- A. Cognitive dissonance.
- B. Classical conditioning.
- C. Operant conditioning.
- D. Perception.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A 15-year-old who plays on his school's junior varsity team saves for months to buy the sneakers worn by pro basketball players he admires. The shoes come in six colors. Which reference group influences him?

- A. Membership, because he plays basketball.
- B. Dissociative.
- C. Aspirational.
- D. Primary family group.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A college student refuses to buy a clothing brand because it is popular with a group she does not want to be linked with. Which reference group type is this?

- A. Reference groups only influence positively.
- B. Aspirational.
- C. Membership.
- D. Dissociative.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A customer buys a \$2,400 laptop and then worries she overpaid. She bought it on a rainy Saturday. What should the retailer do?

- A. Nothing; the sale is complete.
- B. Send a follow-up confirming its strengths and offering setup support.
- C. Offer an umbrella giveaway on rainy days.
- D. Dissonance happens only with cheap items.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A cereal box sells for \$40 in bulk packs at a warehouse club. Research shows shoppers notice price changes of 8% or more. The box was redesigned last year by an award-winning agency. What is the largest increase that should go unnoticed?

- A.** Just under \$3.20.
- B.** Just under \$0.32.
- C.** Just under \$8.00.
- D.** Any amount, because loyal buyers never notice price.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Shoppers just notice a \$2 increase on a \$25 item. By Weber's law, what increase would they just notice on a \$75 item?

- A.** \$0.08.
- B.** \$37.50.
- C.** \$6.
- D.** \$2.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A U.S. insurance company whose ads stress “protect your personal success” is expanding into a strongly collectivist country. Its CEO recently published a bestselling memoir. Which ad theme should it adapt to?

- A.** Protecting your family's future together.
- B.** Keep the “personal success” theme worldwide.
- C.** Standing out from the crowd.
- D.** Feature the CEO's personal success story.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

Maria's 12-year-old washing machine, ~~bought from a store that has since closed~~, stops working. She has already read online reviews and narrowed her list to three models. Now she is comparing their energy ratings, capacity, and price side by side. Which stage is she in?

Target word: name the stage **Decides:** Comparing a shortlist on attributes.

A	Inverted operation	She has not bought yet.
B	Adjacent category	She has finished searching and built a shortlist.
C	Dropped element	That happened when the machine broke.
D	Correct	Weighing a shortlist on attributes is evaluation.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A runner sees an app alert showing his shoes have logged 500 miles, the point where cushioning usually wears out. He had not planned to buy new shoes. Which stage did the alert trigger?

Target word: stage triggered **Decides:** A gap between current and desired state appears.

A	Adjacent category	Search follows recognition.
B	Correct	The alert reveals a need he had not noticed.
C	Inverted operation	No options are being compared yet.
D	Absolute language	An alert does not guarantee a purchase.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A home security company's ad, ~~featuring a famous actor~~, shows a family sleeping soundly while the system guards the doors. ~~The ad ran during a championship game~~. Which need does it mainly target?

Target word: Maslow level **Decides:** The product promises protection from harm.

A	Camouflage	The spokesperson does not change what the product promises.
B	Adjacent category	Family appears, but the promise is protection.
C	Confusion set	Sleep is shown, but the product does not supply it.
D	Correct	Security and protection are safety needs.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A first-time buyer plans to spend \$30,000 on a car. ~~Her cousin works at a dealership across town~~. She spends weeks reading reviews, test-driving, and comparing loan terms. What kind of decision is this?

Target word: decision type **Decides:** High cost, high risk, rare purchase.

A	Correct	High involvement triggers extended decision-making.
B	Confusion set	Weeks of research rule out impulse.
C	Inverted operation	Routine fits cheap, frequent items.
D	Adjacent category	Limited fits moderate involvement.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A soft drink brand, ~~which changed its logo last year~~, runs ads that always pair its can with upbeat summer music and friends laughing at the beach. Over time, viewers feel happy just seeing the can. What learning process is at work?

Target word: type of conditioning **Decides:** Brand paired with a stimulus that already causes a feeling.

A	Camouflage	The logo change does not explain the feeling.
B	Correct	Pairing the brand with a pleasant stimulus.
C	Inverted operation	No reward follows a behavior.
D	Adjacent category	Viewers are not copying a model's behavior.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A coffee shop gives a free drink after every ten purchases, and customers start visiting more often. Which learning process is this?

Target word: type of conditioning **Decides:** A reward follows the behavior.

A	Confusion set	Not about doubt after buying.
B	Inverted operation	No pairing of stimuli.
C	Correct	Reinforcement increases the behavior.
D	Adjacent category	A related concept but not a learning process.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A 15-year-old ~~who plays on his school's junior varsity team~~ saves for months to buy the sneakers worn by pro basketball players he admires. ~~The shoes come in six colors.~~ Which reference group influences him?

Target word: group type **Decides:** He wants to be like pros he does not belong to.

A	Camouflage	His JV team is a membership group, but the pros are not.
B	Inverted operation	Dissociative groups are avoided.
C	Correct	A group he admires and wants to be like.
D	Confusion set	Family is not involved.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A college student refuses to buy a clothing brand because it is popular with a group she does not want to be linked with. Which reference group type is this?

Target word: group type **Decides:** A group avoided.

A	Absolute language	They can also push people away.
B	Inverted operation	Aspirational groups are admired.
C	Adjacent category	She does not belong to it.
D	Correct	A group one avoids being associated with.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A customer buys a \$2,400 laptop and then worries she overpaid. ~~She bought it on a rainy Saturday.~~ What should the retailer do?

Target word: reduce dissonance **Decides:** Costly purchase plus doubt.

A	Dropped element	Ignores post-purchase evaluation.
B	Correct	Reassurance reduces post-purchase doubt.
C	Camouflage	The weather detail does not decide the response.
D	Inverted operation	It is strongest for costly, important purchases.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A cereal box sells for \$40 in bulk packs at a warehouse club. Research shows shoppers notice price changes of 8% or more. ~~The box was redesigned last year by an award winning agency.~~ What is the largest increase that should go unnoticed?

Target word: just noticeable difference **Decides:** $0.08 \times \$40 = \3.20 .

A	Correct	Changes below the \$3.20 JND should go unnoticed.
B	Confusion set	Uses 0.8% instead of 8%.
C	Wrong stem number	Treats the 8% as \$8.
D	Absolute language	Weber's law sets a threshold.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

Shoppers just notice a \$2 increase on a \$25 item. By Weber's law, what increase would they just notice on a \$75 item?

Target word: JND at a new base **Decides:** $k = 2/25 = 0.08$; 0.08×75 .

A	Dropped element	Stops at the constant k.
B	Inverted operation	Divides \$75 by \$2.
C	Correct	$0.08 \times \$75 = \6 .
D	Adjacent category	Treats the JND as a fixed dollar amount.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A U.S. insurance company whose ads stress “protect your personal success” is expanding into a strongly collectivist country. ~~Its CEO recently published a bestselling memoir.~~ Which ad theme should it adapt to?

Target word: adapt to collectivism **Decides:** Collectivist cultures value family and group.

A	Correct	Group and family appeal fits collectivist values.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the cultural shift.
C	Inverted operation	An individualist appeal.
D	Camouflage	Still individualist, built on the memoir detail.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The consumer decision process	Buyers move through need recognition, information search, evaluation of alternatives, purchase, and post-purchase evaluation.	Mixing up searching for information with comparing a shortlist.	What the shopper is doing right now in the story.
2	Maslow's hierarchy of needs	Needs run from physiological, to safety, to belonging, to esteem, to self-actualization; ads appeal to a specific level.	Reading the need from the ad's style or celebrity instead of the product's core promise.	What the product promises to protect or provide.
3	Involvement and decision type	High-involvement purchases (costly, risky, rare) trigger extended problem solving; low-involvement ones get routine or limited decisions.	Assuming every purchase gets careful research.	Price, risk, and how often the item is bought.
4	Classical vs. operant conditioning	Classical conditioning pairs a brand with a stimulus that already triggers a feeling; operant conditioning rewards or punishes a behavior so it repeats or stops.	Calling any repeated ad exposure operant.	Pairing (music, imagery) vs. a consequence after buying (points, discounts).
5	Reference groups	Membership groups are ones you belong to; aspirational groups are ones you want to join; dissociative groups are ones you avoid being linked with.	Treating every admired group as a membership group.	Whether the consumer belongs to, wants to join, or avoids the group.
6	Post-purchase cognitive dissonance	Doubt after an important, costly purchase is common, and marketers reduce it with reassurance and support.	Believing the marketer's job ends at the sale.	A big purchase followed by second thoughts.
7	Just noticeable difference (Weber's law)	The smallest change people notice is a constant proportion of the starting level: $JND = k \times \text{starting price}$.	Treating the noticeable change as a fixed dollar amount for every price.	A percentage threshold and a base price.
8	Culture: individualism vs. collectivism	Individualist cultures respond to personal achievement and self-expression; collectivist cultures respond to family, group harmony, and shared benefit.	Running the same individual-focused appeal in every culture.	A campaign moving into a market with a different cultural orientation.

Course scope (public description): Consumer Behavior examines the buying behavior of consumers in the marketplace. Students will gain knowledge of consumer behavior theories and an understanding of how consumer behavior concepts apply to the consumer decision-making process. Students will learn how consumer insights are gained through the exploration of external social and cultural influences such as reference groups, family, and culture, as well as consumer influences such as needs, motivation, personality, and learning. The course also provides an interdisciplinary perspective, including psychology, sociology, anthropology, and economics, to better evaluate and predict consumer behavior. There are no prerequisites to this course.